

Personality

The word personality itself stems from the Latin word *persona*, which refers to a theatrical mask worn by performers in order to either project different roles or disguise their identities. At its most basic, personality is the characteristic patterns of thoughts, feelings, and behaviours that make a person unique. It is believed that personality arises from within the individual and remains consistent throughout life (Cherry, 2020).

The characteristics or blend of characteristics that makes a person unique is called personality (Weinberg & Gould, 1999).

Characteristics of Personality

According to Cherry (2020), traits and patterns of thoughts and emotions play important role as well as the following are fundamental characteristics of personality:

Consistency. There is generally a recognizable order and regularity to behaviours. Essentially, people act in the same ways or similar ways in a variety of situations.

Psychological and Physiological. Personality is a psychological construct, but research suggests that it is also influenced by biological processes and needs.

Behaviours and Actions. Personality not only influences how we move and respond in our environment, but it also *causes* us to act in certain ways.

Multiple expressions. Personality is displayed in more than just behaviour. It can also be seen in our thoughts, feelings, close relationships, and other social interactions.

Determinants of Personality

According to Janjua (2015), following are the factors which help in shaping one's personality

Heredity. Heredity refers to factors that are determined once an individual is born. An individual's physique, attractiveness, body type, complexion, body weight depends on their parent's biological makeup.

Environment. The environment to which an individual is exposed to during his growing years plays an important role in determining his/her personality. The varied cultures in which we are brought up and our family backgrounds have a crucial role in shaping our personalities.

Situation. An individual's personality also changes with current circumstances and situations. An individual would behave in a different way when he has enough savings with him, and his behaviour would automatically change when he is bankrupt. An individual's appearance, character, intelligence, attractiveness, efficiency, style determine his/her personality.

Development of Personality

Personality development is defined as a process of developing and enhancing one's personality. Personality development helps an individual to gain confidence and high self esteem. Personality development also is said to have a positive impact on one's communication skills and the way he sees the world. Individuals tend to develop a positive attitude as a result of personality development (Janjua, 2015).

According to psychiatrist Erikson (1956), the socialization process of an individual consists of eight phases, each one accompanied by a "psychosocial crisis" that

must be solved if the person is to manage the next and subsequent phases satisfactorily. The stages significantly influence personality development, with five of them occurring during infancy, childhood, and adolescence.

Infancy. During the first two years of life, an infant goes through the first stage: Learning Basic Trust or Mistrust (Hope). Well-nurtured and loved, the infant develops trust and security and a basic optimism. Badly handled, the infant becomes insecure and learns "basic mistrust."

Toddlerhood. The second stage occurs during early childhood, between about 18 months to two years and three to four years of age. It deals with Learning Autonomy or Shame (Will). Well-parented, the child emerges from this stage with self-confidence, elated with his or her newly found control. The early part of this stage can also include stormy tantrums, stubbornness, and negativism, depending on the child's temperament.

Preschool. The third stage occurs during the "play age," or the later preschool years from about three to entry into formal school. The developing child goes through Learning Initiative or Guilt (Purpose). The child learns to use imagination; to broaden skills through active play and fantasy; to cooperate with others; and to lead as well as to follow. If unsuccessful, the child becomes fearful, is unable to join groups, and harbors guilty feelings. The child depends excessively on adults and is restricted both in the development of play skills and in imagination.

School Age. The fourth stage, Learning Industry, or Inferiority (Competence) occurs during school age, up to and possibly including junior high school. The child learns to master more formal skills

- relating with peers according to rules

- progressing from free play to play that is structured by rules and requires teamwork (team sports)
- learning basic intellectual skills (reading, arithmetic)

At this stage, the need for self-discipline increases every year. The child who, because of his or her successful passage through earlier stages, is trusting, autonomous, and full of initiative, will quickly learn to be industrious. However, the mistrusting child will doubt the future and will feel inferior.

Adolescence. The fifth stage, Learning Identity or Identity Diffusion (Fidelity) , occurs during adolescence from age 13 or 14. Maturity starts developing during this time; the young person acquires self-certainty as opposed to self-doubt and experiments with different constructive roles rather than adopting a negative identity, such as delinquency. The well-adjusted adolescent actually looks forward to achievement, and, in later adolescence, clear sexual identity is established. The adolescent seeks leadership (someone to inspire him or her), and gradually develops a set of ideals to live by.

Personality Assessment

According to APA (2011), personality assessment is a proficiency in professional psychology that involves the administration, scoring, and interpretation of empirically supported measures of personality traits and styles to:

- Refine clinical diagnoses
- Structure and inform psychological interventions; and
- Increase the accuracy of behavioural prediction in a variety of contexts and settings (e.g., clinical, forensic, organizational, educational).

A personality test is a tool used to assess human personality. Personality testing and assessment refer to techniques designed to measure the characteristic patterns of traits that people exhibit across various situations. Personality tests can be used to help clarify a clinical diagnosis, guide therapeutic interventions, and help predict how people may respond in different situations (Cherry, 2022).

Types of Personality Tests

There are two types of personality tests which are follows

Objective Personality Tests. An objective test is a psychological test that measures an individual's characteristics in a way that isn't influenced by the examiner's own beliefs; in this way, they are said to be independent of ratter bias. They usually involve the administration of a bank of questions that are marked and compared against standardized scoring mechanisms, in much the same way that school exams are administered. Objective tests tend to have more validity than projective tests. It includes:

1. The big five personality inventory (Goldberg, 1993)
2. Minnesota personality test (Hathaway & McKinley 1943)
3. Sixteen personality factor questionnaires or 16pf questionnaire. (Cattell, 1946)

Big Five Personality Inventory

It is a 44-item inventory that measures an individual on the Big Five Factors (dimensions) of personality (Goldberg, 1993).

Each of the factors is then further divided into personality facets. Contemporary personality psychologists believe that there are five basic dimensions of personality, often referred to as the "Big 5" personality traits. The five broad personality traits described by the

theory are extraversion, agreeableness, openness, conscientiousness, and neuroticism (John & Srivastava, 1999).

The Big Five Personality Test Characteristics

According to Goldberg (1993) following are the personality test characteristics

Openness. Openness reflects curiosity, creativity and seeking novelty as opposed to routine. Open people appreciate the arts, adventures and unusual ideas and take more risks, but may lack focus or be unpredictable. They like careers in the arts and value self-actualization.

Conscientiousness. Conscientious people are dependable, dutiful, self-disciplined, structured, and like to have a plan. They generally work towards a goal in a focused way. They can be perceived as stubborn.

Extroversion. Extroverts seek stimulation and derive energy from others. They are energetic, talkative, sociable, and assertive. They may be considered attention-seeking or domineering.

Agreeableness. Agreeable individuals value people, cooperation, and compassion. They trust and see the best in people, like to help and are good-tempered. Highly agreeable people might be considered gullible, naïve, or submissive.

Neuroticism. Neurotic people tend towards stress, worry, anxiety, perhaps anger and even depression.

Purpose of Big Five Personality Inventory

The primary purpose of Big Five Personality Inventory is to understand the human nature and to get knowledge about the basic traits of a person. It is based on Likert scale and the examinee him/herself from strongly disagree to strongly agree which reveal different aspects of personality (Hayes et al., 2003).

Advantages and Disadvantages

One of the greatest advantages of any personality test is it provides a basis for an individual to understand themselves. By categorizing behaviours into a term, one can reflect and explore how they adhere to those definitions. One of the disadvantages of any personality test is that these are self-reported surveys. This requires that an individual has the level of self-awareness to answer these questions accurately. Another criticism of the Big Five Personality Traits is that the categories are too broad and absolute to provide any real insight. Humans are reactive creatures that change depending on the scenario. For example, you may be open in situations where you are with close friends, and less open in foreign situations (Quan, 2021).

Interpretation of Big Five Personality Test

According to Raypole (2019), interpretation of big five personality inventory is as follows

Openness. The openness trait reflects how willing is candidate the to explore new opportunities and ideas within an organization. The score they receive will determine how 'inquisitive' they are in new situations, and how open they are to new ideas.

High Openness Score. If they receive a high score in the 'openness' category, candidates are willing to take new experiences in their stride. They can be highly creative,

bringing new ideas to the table, and often use their imagination to make positive changes in the work environment. A candidate with a high openness score will cope well with changes at work but will struggle with repetitive, mundane tasks that lack creativity and require logic.

Low Openness Score. If candidates receive a low openness score, however, they typically prefer methodical and logical approaches to their work. They are also less likely to embrace change, preferring to maintain the status quo in terms of their work style.

Conscientiousness. The conscientious personality trait represents candidate's attention to detail and diligence. It indicates how prepared candidates are, and whether they are likely to work to a particular schedule.

High Conscientiousness Score. Candidates who receive a high score in the 'conscientious' category generally prefer structured, ordered approaches to their work. They are not only ambitious but will also use their determination and preparedness to achieve their goals. Candidates with conscientious personalities are hard workers who use schedules and plans to optimize their work.

Low Conscientiousness Score. If a candidate has a low conscientiousness score, they might tend to be much more flexible in their approach to work. Structures aren't always required for candidates with low conscientiousness scores, and they don't rely heavily on being organized. This might make it challenging for such candidates to meet strict deadlines or manage their time efficiently.

Extraversion. Extraversion as a personality trait measures how well your candidates perform when interacting with colleagues, and how much they gain energy

from collaborating with co-workers. It also indicates how comfortable they are sharing ideas with team members.

High Extraversion Score. If candidates score highly in the extraversion category, they are typically energized when interacting with co-workers, and tend to be more productive in team discussions. However, working independently might sometimes be a challenge for those who have a high extraversion score.

Low Extraversion Score. On the other hand, a low extraversion score indicates that candidates might prefer working independently on projects and achieve their best work working alone. They might tend to struggle with collaborating or discussing ideas with team members.

Agreeableness. The agreeableness personality trait indicates the extent to which candidates assist others. The agreeable trait can be summed up by the goal to ensure all tasks and interactions with co-workers run like clockwork without problems or errors.

High Agreeableness Score. A candidate with a high agreeableness score is likely to assist others with challenging tasks. They are also happy to collaborate with team members and work towards resolving problems in the workplace. In other words, their agreeable trait makes them good problem solvers.

Low Agreeableness Score. If candidate has a low agreeableness score, they might tend to be more forceful with their opinions. They can be headstrong in their ideas. This means candidates with low agreeableness scores might need to work on being more sympathetic to others' views and try to ensure they listen to other team members' perspectives more.

Neuroticism. The neurotic personality trait represents the extent to which candidate's emotions influence their judgment at work, as well as their decisions and interactions, and how they carry out their projects. It also refers to whether your candidates can cope well in high-pressure environments, and whether or not they can set emotions to one side in the work environment.

High Neuroticism Score. Candidates who score highly in terms of neuroticism typically find working in high-pressure situations a challenge. They prefer calmer work environments, which make it easier for them to avoid stress. In high-pressure work situations, candidates with high neuroticism scores are likely to struggle with their emotions and be highly concerned when they make mistakes.

Low Neuroticism Score. In contrast, if candidates have a low neuroticism score, they can work in a more stable, predictable way, despite high-pressure situations. Your candidates will also have a more positive outlook in terms of challenging projects and are generally more optimistic. Staying calm where others might become stressed in the workplace comes naturally to those who have a low neuroticism score.

Scoring

The BFI consists of 44 items which are rated on a five-point Likert scale from 1 (disagree a lot) to 5 (agree a lot). The BFI yields five primary scales. Descriptions of the scales and item loadings are listed below. Scale scores are calculated as the sum of respective items. Bold items are reverse.

Item Coding

SCALE NAME (ABBR.)	DESCRIPTION	ITEM LOADINGS
BFI_EXT	Extraversion Subscale	1, 6R, 11, 16, 21R, 26, 31R, 36
BFI_AGR	Agreeableness Subscale	2R, 7, 12R, 17, 22, 27R, 32, 37R, 42
BFI_CON	Conscientiousness Subscale	3, 8R, 13, 18R, 23R, 28, 33, 38, 43R
BFI_NEU	Neuroticism Subscale	4, 9, 14, 19, 24R, 29, 34R, 39
BFI_OPEN	Openness Subscale	5, 10, 15, 20, 25, 30, 35R, 40, 41R, 44

Method and Results

Apparatus

- Pen/pencil
- Big Five Inventory
- Big five Inventory Scoring Manual

Administration

As per the instructions read carefully, items were responded. There were statements that indicated the extent to which one agree or disagree with the statement i.e. disagree strongly, disagree a little, neither agree nor disagree, agree a little or agree strongly.

Self-Analysis

Demographic Details

Name H. A.

Age 21 years

Gender Female

Results

Big five dimension	Extraversion	Agreeableness	Conscientiousness	Neuroticism	Openness
Score	31	34	31	25	39
Aggregate	62.5%	85%	77%	62.5%	97.5%

Interpretation

The above score is high on the trait openness which shows the presence of following qualities; highly creative, bringing new ideas to the table, and often use imagination to make positive changes in the work environment, struggle with repetitive, mundane (dull) tasks that lack creativity and require logic.

Peer Analysis

Demographic Details

Name A. A.

Age 21 years

Gender Female

Results

Big five dimension	Extraversion	Agreeableness	Conscientiousness	Neuroticism	Openness
Score	27	36	32	22	34
Aggregate	67.5%	90%	80%	55%	85%

Interpretation

The above score is high on the trait of agreeableness which shows the presence of following qualities; kind, generous, trusting, trustworthy, helpful, and willing to compromise her interests with others. The peer analysis also shows an optimistic view of human nature.